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**Let's build
a start-up
ecosystem that
prioritises
profitability
over hype,
impact over
vanity, and
innovation
over imitation**

A NEW ERA FOR START-UPS

With India approaching its centennial in 2047, it is seeing a dawn of the golden era of Indian start-ups

▶ **AS INDIA MARCHES** towards its centennial in 2047, we stand at the cusp of an unprecedented opportunity—one that demands we fundamentally reimagine how we fund, build, and scale start-ups that can shape the nation's destiny. This is not just about chasing the next billion-dollar company; it's about nurturing a generation of founders who will build enduring, profitable businesses that solve India's most pressing problems and contribute meaningfully to our economy.

Over the last decade, we've seen India's start-up ecosystem grow from a handful of fledgling companies to a vibrant, global powerhouse. The emergence of 'Indicorns'—Indian start-ups that achieve not just scale but also profitability—marks a pivotal shift. Companies like Ofbusiness, Unicommerce, and Razorpay have proven that it's possible to build sustainable, capital-efficient businesses that deliver real value. This is the dawn of the Golden Era of Indian Start-ups—where profitability is not an afterthought, but a core metric of success.

I truly believe that the Golden Era of Indian Startups is just beginning. Why?

• **Global markets are more accessible than ever,** and

Indian founders, leveraging the talent density in India are building global products from day one. AI applications seamlessly transcend geographic boundaries.

• **Digital rails in India—UPI, ONDC, Aadhaar, Account Aggregator**—provide a unique competitive advantage that no other country can replicate.

• **Domestic capital is finally stepping up.** With sovereign funds, family offices, and large institutions starting to back Indian innovation, we can break free from dependence on global capital cycles.

But this is not enough. For India to unlock its potential, we need to think bigger, bolder, and longer-term.

However, if we are to unlock India's full potential, the venture investing model itself must evolve. The traditional VC model, which optimised for quick exits and rapid top-line growth, has its merits but it often falls short in addressing the unique needs of a country like India. We must fund long-term bets, deep tech innovations, and Bharat-first solutions that may not fit neatly into the "growth at all costs" narrative but are crucial for our progress. Start-ups working on defence technologies, agritech, healthcare, and climate tech need patient capital, strategic support, and a bold vision for the long haul. The most enduring companies in